

"There were never two vampires. There were five hungers wearing one face."



THE SANGREAL

A VAMPIRE CLASS FOR AVARA

Second Edition · Base Class · Four Bloodlines · Feats · Magic Items · the Progenitor's Fang

THE SANGREAL

❖ A VAMPIRE CLASS FOR AVARA — SECOND EDITION

I. LORE — THE PROGENITOR AND THE FIVE BLOODLINES

Before Aalise Bathory ever claimed the title of Sang Éternel, before the five-tier hierarchy existed to measure a vampire's age and power, there was only **the Progenitor** — a nameless first predator whose blood, when it finally split among those it turned, did not carry over cleanly. It fractured into five different *answers* to the same unbearable question: *how do you go on living as something that isn't human anymore?*

Those five answers became the five Bloodlines. Every vampire built from this class is a **Sangreal** — "of the true blood" — and carries one fragment of the Progenitor's fractured nature, whether they know its origin or not.

This split gives Avara's vampires two independent axes instead of one. **The Sang Perdu → Sang Éternel hierarchy measures age and power** — how far a vampire has climbed since their turning. **Bloodline measures nature** — which of the five hungers they were born into, regardless of how old or powerful they become.

One thread worth a GM's attention: **the Bloodline of the Hollow Crown is Aalise Bathory's own.** Every PC who takes it is either a rare scion she has personally acknowledged — or, more interesting at most tables, an unsanctioned branch of her bloodline that she doesn't yet know exists.

Four of the five Bloodlines are complete in this document. The Broken Fang — the hunger that never made peace with itself — is still being finalized and isn't included here yet.

❖ QUICK GLOSSARY

TERM	WHAT IT MEANS
Hunger	Your resource pool. A small number, recharges on a short rest. Everything in this class spends from it.
The Bite	Your damage amplifier — spend Hunger on any hit for extra necrotic damage.

TERM	WHAT IT MEANS
Blood Sorcery	The umbrella name for your other Hunger-spent abilities (Blood Rush, Sanguine Ward, Blood Siphon, Compulsion).
Bloodstarved	What happens if a Bite spend drops you to 0 Hunger — disadvantage on all saves until you rest. One clean flag, not a formula.
Compulsion DC	8 + your proficiency bonus + your Charisma modifier. Used any time a feature says a creature "saves against your Compulsion."

II. CLASS BASICS

- **Hit Die:** d8
- **Primary Ability:** Dexterity (attacks), Charisma (Blood Sorcery, Compulsion DC)
- **Saving Throws:** Dexterity, Charisma
- **Armor:** Light armor
- **Weapons:** Simple weapons, martial melee weapons, hand crossbows
- **Skills:** Choose 3 — Stealth, Insight, Persuasion, Intimidation, Investigation, Perception, Acrobatics

III. HUNGER

"You do not decide to feed. You decide, for one more moment, not to."

One resource, recharging on a short rest — the whole system.

TIER	HUNGER
1–4	3
5–10	5
11–16	6
17–20	8

Compulsion DC = 8 + proficiency bonus + Charisma modifier. This is the number every "save against your Compulsion" reference in this document means.

Regaining Hunger: you regain 1 Hunger whenever you score a critical hit or reduce a creature to 0 HP.

Bloodstarved: if spending Hunger on The Bite drops you to 0, you're Bloodstarved until you finish a short or long rest — disadvantage on all saving throws. One condition, no scaling, nothing to calculate.

IV. CLASS FEATURES BY LEVEL

❖ LEVEL 1 — VAMPIRIC TRAITS, HUNGER, THE BITE, BLOODSTARVED

Darkvision 60 ft., you no longer need to breathe, resistance to necrotic damage, and you no longer age.

The Bite: on any hit, spend any number of Hunger as part of the same attack — **+2d8 necrotic damage per Hunger spent**, no upper limit beyond what you're holding. See Section III for Hunger, regaining it, and Bloodstarved.

❖ LEVEL 2 — BLOOD SORCERY

Both cost 1 Hunger each: - **Blood Rush** (bonus action): your speed doubles until the end of the turn, and you don't provoke opportunity attacks. If you end that movement within 10 ft. of an enemy you weren't already next to, your first attack against it this turn has advantage. - **Sanguine Ward** (reaction, when hit by a creature within 10 ft.): resistance to that instance of damage, and the attacker has disadvantage on its next attack roll before the end of its next turn.

❖ LEVEL 3 — BLOODLINE

Choose your Bloodline. Grants a feature now and again at 8, 11, 15, and 18.

❖ LEVEL 5 — EXTRA ATTACK

You attack twice, not once, whenever you take the Attack action. Hunger pool rises to 5 (see Section III).

❖ LEVEL 6 — BLOOD SIPHON

Action, 1 Hunger: melee or ranged spell attack, 2d10 necrotic — and you regain HP equal to half the damage dealt.

❖ **LEVEL 7 — DREADFUL GAZE**

Action, 2 per long rest: every creature within 30 ft. that can see you saves against your Compulsion DC or is frightened for 1 minute.

❖ **LEVEL 8 — BLOODLINE**

Your second Bloodline feature.

❖ **LEVEL 9 — COMPULSION**

Reaction, 1 Hunger: when an enemy creature within 10 ft. of you makes an attack roll or casts a spell targeting anyone, it must succeed a save against your Compulsion DC or the attack/spell redirects to a different valid target of your choice, within that attack or spell's own original range.

❖ **LEVEL 10 — IMPROVED BITE**

The Bite now deals +3d8 necrotic per Hunger spent, instead of +2d8.

❖ **LEVEL 11 — BLOODLINE**

Your third Bloodline feature.

❖ **LEVEL 13 — DEEPER HUNGER**

Blood Siphon can take extra Hunger when cast: for each additional Hunger spent, +1d10 necrotic (the healing scales with it too, since it's still half the damage dealt).

❖ **LEVEL 14 — UNDYING WILL**

The first time you'd become Bloodstarved each long rest, you don't.

❖ **LEVEL 15 — BLOODLINE**

Your fourth Bloodline feature.

❖ **LEVEL 17 — RAVENOUS**

You also regain 1 Hunger whenever you reduce a creature to half its hit points or below (once per turn), in addition to the crit/kill triggers from Section III.

❖ **LEVEL 18 — BLOODLINE CAPSTONE**

Your Bloodline's final feature.

❖ LEVEL 20 — THE UNDYING FEAST (CAPSTONE)

Bonus action, once per long rest: for 1 minute, Blood Rush, Sanguine Ward, Compulsion, and Blood Siphon all cost no Hunger. The Bite is deliberately untouched — its entire design is spending Hunger for bigger damage, so every point of Hunger you generate during this minute goes straight into it instead of being split across four other abilities.

V. LEVEL PROGRESSION TABLE

LVL	FEATURE
1	Vampiric Traits, Hunger, The Bite, Bloodstarved
2	Blood Rush, Sanguine Ward
3	Bloodline
4	ASI
5	Extra Attack, Hunger → 5
6	Blood Siphon
7	Dreadful Gaze
8	Bloodline feature
9	Compulsion
10	Improved Bite
11	Bloodline feature
12	ASI
13	Deeper Hunger
14	Undying Will
15	Bloodline feature
16	ASI
17	Ravenous

LVL	FEATURE
18	Bloodline capstone
19	ASI
20	The Undying Feast

VI. THE ROLEPLAY TOOLKIT

No combat value — the texture of being a vampire between fights.

- **Compulsion (social)** — look-in-the-eyes command or memory edit on a mortal; binary save against your Compulsion DC, scaling in difficulty with the target's willpower.
- **Heartbeat Sense** — passive lie/emotion reading at close range.
- **No Reflection / No Heat Signature** — flavor with real puzzle and stealth-detection consequences.
- **Threshold Law** — cannot cross into a private home uninvited.
- **Blood Memory** — drinking blood grants flashes of the drinker's recent memories.
- **Animal Command (minor)** — bats, rats, wolves answer you.
- **Daylight Clock** — sun vulnerability, a standing narrative pressure rather than a mechanical tax during ordinary play.

VII. THE BLOODLINES

✧ BLOODLINE OF THE HOLLOW CROWN

Aalise Bathory's own line. Aggressive protection — bait the hit, punish the attacker, shrug off what lands.

Level 3 - Bodyguard's Reach: Compulsion's range extends to 30 ft. whenever the triggering attack or spell targets an ally instead of you. - **The Toll:** whenever a creature fails its save against your Compulsion, choose

one — it takes necrotic damage equal to your Charisma modifier (minimum 1), or you regain 1 Hunger. - **Blood Ward** (bonus action, 1 Hunger): resistance to all damage until the start of your next turn.

Level 8 — Thorned Ward While Blood Ward's resistance is active, whenever a creature hits you, your next attack against that creature (before the end of your next turn) has advantage and deals an extra 2d6 necrotic damage.

Level 11 — Second Command Compulsion is no longer limited to once per round — use it again the same round for an additional 1 Hunger each time.

Level 15 — Unshakable Crown While you hold at least 1 Hunger, advantage on saves against being frightened or charmed. A creature that has already failed a save against your Compulsion this encounter has disadvantage on further saves against it.

Level 18 — The Crown Does Not Fall (Capstone) Bonus action, once per long rest: activate for 1 minute. While active, whenever an ally within your movement range is hit by an attack, use your reaction to move there (your actual movement — Blood Rush and any speed boost extends your reach) and intercept it — you take the damage instead, with resistance, and the attacker must succeed a save against your Compulsion DC or lose its reaction until the start of your next turn. Each time this saves an ally from dropping to 0 HP, you regain all your expended Hunger.

❖ BLOODLINE OF THE RED HUNT

Turned, not born. Momentum that pays for itself — chase, chain, never stop moving.

Level 3 - Predator's Momentum: Blood Rush's advantage applies to every attack you make that turn, not just the first. If none of your attacks that turn land, you don't lose the Hunger spent on it. - **Blood Debt Repaid:** whenever you reduce a creature to 0 HP, regain the Hunger you spent on Blood Rush this turn. - **Twin Fangs:** once per turn, when you hit a creature, spend 1 Hunger to immediately move up to half your speed without provoking opportunity attacks, then make one additional weapon attack against a different creature.

Level 8 — Wounded Prey The Bite deals an extra 1d8 necrotic against a creature at or below half its hit points, at no added cost.

Level 11 — Relentless Fangs Twin Fangs can trigger more than once per turn — each additional use beyond the first costs 1 Hunger.

Level 15 — Unbroken Chase Opportunity attacks against you have disadvantage. If you've moved 20+ ft. since the start of your turn, all your attacks this turn have advantage.

Level 18 — The Hunt Never Ends (Capstone) Bonus action, once per long rest: for 1 minute, Blood Rush costs no Hunger, and Twin Fangs triggers automatically — no cost, no per-turn limit — whenever you hit a creature.

❖ BLOODLINE OF THE WEeping VEIL

Bonds over domination. Feeding your ally is what protects them.

Level 3 - Shared Feast: Blood Siphon's healing can target an ally within 30 ft. instead of yourself. - **Given Freely** (passive): whenever you heal yourself from any Blood Sorcery ability, the nearest ally within 30 ft. also heals for half as much, automatically. - **Bonded** (free action, once per rest): name one willing ally as your Bonded creature, replacing any earlier bond. Whenever you heal your Bonded ally, they gain resistance to the next attack that hits them, before the start of your next turn.

Level 8 — Twinned Wound Reaction, no cost: when you take damage, your Bonded ally (if within 30 ft.) may use their own reaction to take half of it instead of you — their choice, not yours.

Level 11 — Devoted Strike Once per turn, when your Bonded ally is hit by an attack, spend 1 Hunger to immediately make one weapon attack against the attacker as a reaction.

Level 15 — Inseparable While within 30 ft. of your Bonded ally, you both have advantage on saves against being charmed or frightened, and Given Freely's shared healing doubles to a full amount instead of half.

Level 18 — Til Death, and After (Capstone) Bonus action, once per long rest: activate for 1 minute. While active, the first time your Bonded ally would be reduced to 0 HP during that window, they drop to 1 instead, and you take necrotic damage equal to half the damage that would have felled them. For the full minute, healing you grant your Bonded ally is maximized instead of rolled, and Given Freely's splash reaches every ally within 30 ft., not just the nearest one.

❖ BLOODLINE OF THE ASHEN COURT

Centuries of accumulated knowledge. Precision that doesn't miss and doesn't care what resists it.

Level 3 - Practiced Wound: The Bite ignores resistance to necrotic damage entirely, and treats immunity to necrotic damage as resistance instead. - **Marked Weakness** (passive): once per turn, when you hit a creature, you may mark it as your Studied target until the end of your next turn (replacing any previous mark). Attacks against your Studied target — yours or an ally's — have advantage. - **Guaranteed Cut:** once per short rest, no cost: one attack roll you make automatically hits.

Level 8 — Anatomist's Draw Blood Siphon against your Studied target deals an extra 1d10 necrotic, and the healing you gain from it is maximized instead of rolled.

Level 11 — Second Cut Guaranteed Cut can be used a second time per short rest, but the second use costs 1 Hunger.

Level 15 — Nothing Left to Chance While you have a Studied target, you have advantage on saving throws against anything that target does to you, and your Compulsion against it never gains disadvantage from prior failed saves.

Level 18 — The Perfect Cut (Capstone) Once per long rest: your next attack against your Studied target automatically hits and crits, ignores all its resistances and immunities outright, and deals maximum damage. Until the end of the encounter, every ally attacking that same creature also ignores its resistances and immunities.

VIII. FEATS

Kept deliberately small — this class no longer has the sprawling sub-systems that used to justify a large feat list. A handful of clean, meaningful choices instead.

❖ GENERAL FEATS

- **Deep Well** (*Full*) — Max Hunger increases by 1 at every tier.
- **Efficient Feeding** (*Half, +1 Con*) — Once per short rest, cast any Blood Sorcery ability for free.
- **Feral Recovery** (*Half, +1 Wis or Con*) — When you reduce a creature to 0 HP, also regain 1d4 HP, in addition to the Hunger you already regain.

❖ HOLLOW CROWN FEATS

- **Bodyguard's Instinct** (*Full*) — Bodyguard's Reach no longer requires a save to trigger against an ally — automatic, but The Toll's choice is unavailable on those triggers.
- **Unyielding Ward** (*Half, +1 Con*) — Once per short rest, Blood Ward can be triggered as a reaction, the instant before you're hit, instead of only as a bonus action.

❖ RED HUNT FEATS

- **Twin Hunt** (*Full*) — Twin Fangs' first use each turn costs no Hunger.
- **Fleet Fangs** (*Half, +1 Dex*) — Twin Fangs' movement increases from half your speed to your full speed.

❖ WEEPING VEIL FEATS

- **Distant Bond** (*Full*) — Shared Feast, Twinned Wound, and Devoted Strike's range all extend to 60 ft.
- **Shared Vigor** (*Half, +1 Con or Wis*) — Once per long rest, Given Freely's splash healing also removes one level of exhaustion from the ally it reaches.

❖ ASHEN COURT FEATS

- **Perfect Study** (*Full*) — Marked Weakness's mark no longer requires a hit — bonus action, no cost, mark any creature you can see as Studied.
- **Keener Eye** (*Half, +1 Int or Wis*) — Once per short rest, Guaranteed Cut can target an ally's attack roll instead of your own.

IX. MAGIC ITEMS

One Rare, one Very Rare, one Legendary — per Bloodline.

❖ HOLLOW CROWN

- **Rare — Warding Collar:** Requires attunement. Blood Ward can be activated as a reaction, once per short rest.
- **Very Rare — Gauntlet of the Unshaken:** Requires attunement. Second Command's additional Compulsion uses cost 1 less Hunger (minimum 1).
- **Legendary — Crown of the Undying** (*Hollow Crown only*): The Crown Does Not Fall can be activated twice per long rest, and while active, Blood Ward costs no Hunger.

❖ RED HUNT

- **Rare — Boots of the Endless Chase:** Requires attunement. Blood Rush's advantage no longer requires ending within 10 ft. of an enemy — any enemy you moved past this turn qualifies.
- **Very Rare — Necklace of Torn Prey:** Requires attunement. Wounded Prey's threshold rises from half HP to 75% HP.
- **Legendary — Mantle of the Undying Hunt** (*Red Hunt only*): The Hunt Never Ends usable twice per long rest; your speed doubles while it's active.

❖ WEeping VEIL

- **Rare — Locket of the Bonded Heart:** Requires attunement. Twinned Wound can trigger even if your Bonded ally has already used their reaction this round, once per short rest.
- **Very Rare — Chalice of Shared Blood:** Requires attunement. Given Freely's splash always heals the full amount, not half — Inseparable's benefit, early.
- **Legendary — The Weeping Veil** (*Weeping Veil only*): Til Death, and After usable twice per long rest; its maximized-healing effect also applies to Shared Feast during that window.

❖ ASHEN COURT

- **Rare — Loupe of Marked Prey:** Requires attunement. Marked Weakness's mark also gives the Studied target disadvantage on saves against your Compulsion.
- **Very Rare — Scalpel of the Ashen Court:** Requires attunement. Guaranteed Cut recharges an additional use per short rest.
- **Legendary — Codex of the Ashen Court** (*Ashen Court only*): The Perfect Cut usable twice per long rest; its party-wide bypass also grants advantage against that creature, not just the resistance/immunity ignore.

X. THE ARTIFACT — THE PROGENITOR'S FANG

A dagger-fanged relic of the very first vampire. It does not favor a Bloodline.

- **Levels 1–4:** +1 to attack and damage rolls. Your necrotic resistance becomes immunity while attuned.
- **Levels 5–10:** +2 to attack and damage. Once per long rest, you may ignore becoming Bloodstarved — a second safety net stacking with Undying Will once you reach it.
- **Levels 11–16:** +3 to attack and damage. When you spend 3 or more Hunger on a single use of The Bite, add one extra die free.
- **Levels 17–20:** +3 retained. Once per long rest, bonus action: instantly restore all expended Hunger.

The Fang is faintly sentient, and hungers on its own account: advantage on Intimidation checks against anyone who's seen it drink, disadvantage on Persuasion checks with anyone innocent enough to sense what it is.

XI. DESIGNER NOTES — ON THE REDESIGN

What changed between the first version of this class and this one, and why, kept general rather than tied to specific numbers.

Playtesting beats theorycrafting every time. The first version of this class passed every internal check we ran against it — DPR benchmarks, nova ratios, feat classification — and still turned out to be confusing and underwhelming at the actual table. Metrics catch numerical problems; they don't catch a class that's too complicated to enjoy playing. There's no substitute for someone actually running the character through a session and reporting back how it *felt*, not just how it measured.

Systems compound — count how many a player has to track simultaneously, not just whether each one is individually reasonable. The old version's resource pool, risk formula, two-mode targeting choice, and per-subclass reskin of that choice were each defensible in isolation. Stacked together, a player had to hold four interacting systems in their head before a subclass feature even entered the picture. The fix wasn't to simplify any one of them further — it was to cut most of them and rebuild around a single resource doing every job.

One resource spent multiple ways beats several resources spent one way each. The redesign borrows this directly from how a Hexadin actually plays: one pool (spell slots), spent on damage (Smite) or utility (spells), recharging fast enough that the player rarely feels starved. Reusing a single pool across a damage amplifier, a mobility tool, a defensive reaction, and a healing spell means there's only ever one number to track, and every choice is "what do I spend it on this time," not "which of my three resources applies here."

A binary risk flag reads faster at the table than a scaling formula, even when the formula is mathematically cleaner. The original risk mechanic was a single elegant equation. It was still something a player had to compute mid-combat. Replacing it with a yes/no state — you're Bloodstarved or you aren't — trades a small amount of design elegance for a large amount of table speed, and table speed matters more.

Subclass features should reuse the base kit's verbs, not introduce new ones. Every Bloodline in this redesign modifies Blood Rush, Sanguine Ward, Blood Siphon, or Compulsion rather than adding a fifth or sixth new ability. A player who knows the base class already knows most of what their Bloodline does — they're just learning new conditions attached to familiar buttons, not memorizing an entirely separate toolkit.

When two Bloodlines' signature moments start to resemble each other, fix it by changing the axis, not just the flavor text. Two capstones independently arrived at "negate an ally's death" during this redesign. Reskinning one wouldn't have solved the actual problem — they were mechanically the same idea. The fix was giving them different resources to spend (movement and a reaction vs. a direct HP trade through a bond) so the two moments are structurally distinct, not just narratively distinct.

A capstone gated behind one precise trigger is a capstone that might never fire. Two capstones in this redesign were originally reactive, waiting on a specific bad event (an ally hitting exactly 0 HP) that a competent, well-supported party might simply never produce. Converting both to an activated window — turned on before a dangerous fight, covering a full minute — fixed the same problem in both places at once, and it's worth checking any other "waits for disaster" design against this same failure mode.

"Five hungers. One blood. The Progenitor never meant to make five different answers — it only meant to survive one more night. Everything after that was just its children arguing about how."